

TB anatomy

A SystemVerilog testbench is a simulation-only wrapper around a design under test

Classic AND testbench sketch

- Starter picture: a tiny AND gate DUT with inputs a and b and output y
- In the TB, a and b are regs, you procedural-assign them in initial
- Y is a wire, the DUT drives it; the TB reads it but does not assign it
- The instance wires ports: dut dot a to a, dut dot b to b, dut dot y to y
- An initial block applies vectors with hash delays, display the result, then finish
- Step the timeline and you see stimulus, propagation, print, and end-of-sim in order

Browser lab

Digital Design and Verification Platform

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INTERACTIVE TOOL

Testbench anatomy explorer

See how a Verilog **testbench** wraps a **DUT**: stimulus (reg/logic), observed nets (wire), instance ports, then \$display / \$finish. Starter: a 2-input AND with a tiny initial that prints y and ends simulation.

Starter example: and2 DUT with reg a,b / wire y, \$display of y, then \$finish. Click anatomy parts and Step the timeline.

Challenge 0 / 22 cleared

Quiz: DUT: DUT means...

☐ Design Under Test — the synthesizable (or RTL) module being verified

☐ Device Upload Tool

☐ only the \$finish statement

☐ the forever clock generator alone

Show hint

Check

Next

Load challenge setup

Idle

Quiz: DUT

Quiz: testbench

Quiz: reg in TB

Quiz: wire observe

Quiz: \$display

Quiz: \$finish

Quiz: synth

Quiz: logic

Quiz: who makes clk

Quiz: no \$finish

Load starter

Select DUT

Select stimulus

Inspect a

Browser lab starter

Real SV TB track practice

- In the real track, open this module's examples prompts
- Restate TB anatomy in one sentence, wrapper, stimulus, DUT, observe, finish
- Sketch the AND testbench on paper
- Optional: map the same regions to a cocotb or Verilator test you already have
- No full compile required yet, the goal is to recognize the skeleton in real code

Pitfalls to watch

- Do not procedural-assign a wire in initial, that is a classic compile or runtime mistake
- Do not drive a DUT output from the TB
- Do not confuse the DUT module with the TB module, only the wrapper is simulation-only
- And remember

Your turn

- Complete the checklist for at least one track, preferably both
- In the browser, load starter, step through display and finish
- On paper, draw one TB block diagram with stimulus, DUT, and observe labeled
- When you are ready, take the short quiz, then continue to self-checking testbenches